

01

REASON IN RELIGION □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Role (2024 PYQ): reason (a) constructs natural theology (proofs for God), (b) tests coherence of doctrines, (c) interprets scripture, (d) defends faith (apologetics). □

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Rationalism: religious beliefs must meet the bar of reason/evidence (Clifford: "it is wrong always... to believe anything upon insufficient evidence"). □

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Limits: proofs are inconclusive (see Proofs note); the transcendent may exceed reason → space for revelation & faith. □□

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: Role (2024 PYQ): reason (a) constructs natural theology (proofs for God), (b) tests coherence of doctrines, (c) interprets scripture, (d) defends faith (apologetics). □

ANSWER LINE: Role (2024 PYQ): reason (a) constructs natural theology (proofs for God), (b) tests coherence of doctrines, (c) interprets scripture, (d) defends faith (apologetics). □

02

REVELATION □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Recommended opening definition: Revelation is an alleged divine self-disclosure that supplies truth or presence unavailable to unaided reason.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Core argument/criticism: Propositional models emphasise revealed truths, whereas non-propositional models emphasise divine acts or presence interpreted through human experience.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Core argument/criticism: Propositional models emphasise revealed truths, whereas non-propositional models emphasise divine acts or presence interpreted through human experience.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Non-propositional view (Hick): revelation is God's acts/self-presence in history & experience, humanly interpreted — not a set of dictated propositions.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

03

FAITH □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Recommended opening definition: Faith is firm trust and commitment that goes beyond conclusive proof without necessarily opposing reason.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Core argument/criticism: Aquinas explains faith as intellectual assent commanded by the will, while Kierkegaard stresses passionate commitment under objective uncertainty.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Core argument/criticism: Aquinas explains faith as intellectual assent commanded by the will, while Kierkegaard stresses passionate commitment under objective uncertainty.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Definition: faith = trust in and commitment to God/the transcendent, involving assent that goes beyond conclusive proof (but not necessarily against reason).

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

04

THE FOUR STANCES — comparison □□

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ Aquinas is the balanced default: reason & revelation cannot conflict (both from God); reason proves the preambles, revelation supplies the mysteries; faith is intellectual assent under grace.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Recommended opening definition: The reason-faith debate concerns whether evidence, trust or distinct sources should govern religious assent.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Core argument/criticism: Rationalism risks reducing faith to proof, fideism risks arbitrariness, while harmony and two-source theories preserve rational scrutiny without collapsing mystery into demonstration.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Final verdict: Aquinas offers the most balanced model when reason establishes preambles and faith assents to mysteries that exceed but do not contradict reason.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

05

FOUNDATIONAL STATEMENT BANK □□

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

2. □ Aquinas places faith between demonstrative knowledge and wavering opinion: it is firm assent to what is not seen.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

2. □ Aquinas places faith between demonstrative knowledge and wavering opinion: it is firm assent to what is not seen.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

3. □ Kierkegaard links faith with passionate inward commitment under objective uncertainty.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

2. □ Aquinas places faith between demonstrative knowledge and wavering opinion: it is firm assent to what is not seen.

ANSWER LINE: 1. □ The Augustinian–Anselmian formula *credo ut intelligam* presents faith as seeking understanding.

06

APPLIED-QUESTION DRILLS □□

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

1. [Aquinas] "How does Aquinas' faith-as-'intellectual assent' reconcile reason & faith?" (2025) → §3.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

2. [Reason] "Role of reason in religion." (2024) → §1.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

6. [Science] "Significance of religion vis-à-vis present scientific and technological development." (2020, 10m) → §9.6 — Barbour's four models, not a Galileo narrative.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

6. [Science] "Significance of religion vis-à-vis present scientific and technological development." (2020, 10m) → §9.6 — Barbour's four models, not a Galileo narrative.

ANSWER LINE: 1. [Aquinas] "How does Aquinas' faith-as-'intellectual assent' reconcile reason & faith?" (2025) → §3.

07

INDIAN–WESTERN PARITY BENCH □□

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Recommended opening definition: Indian epistemology reframes reason and revelation through *pramāṇa* (means of valid knowledge), especially *śabda* (verbal testimony).

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Core argument/criticism: *Mīmāṃsā* (Vedic exegesis) defends authorless scripture and intrinsic validity, while *Nyāya* (logic and realist epistemology) requires externally confirmed credibility.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM